Americas Payment Technology: Consumer Spending Update: October Fiserv SMB spend stable with improving transaction trends

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Bottom Line:

Fiserv recently updated the Fiserv Small Business Index for the month of October. Spending growth stepped up modestly in October, rising 2.3% on a seasonally adjusted (SA) basis compared to 2.2% in September, while non-seasonally adjusted (NSA) growth fell to 1.3% from 2.4%. Transactions declined at a slower pace in October (-1.3% vs. -2.0% YoY in September) alongside a deceleration in average ticket sizes which grew 3.6% YoY in October (vs. 4.3% in September). FISV noted that Essentials spend growth (2.7% YoY) continued to outpace Discretionary spend growth (2.0% YoY) in October with essentials continuing to accelerate (2.4%/2.0% YoY in September Essential/Discretionary). Retail sector growth fell following the strong September (1.9% YoY in October vs. 3.0% in September)as back-to-school and Labor Day timing effects lapsed. Restaurant growth improved in October (-0.5% YoY vs. -1.0% in September) as both pricing and foot traffic growth rose from September.

Overall, we see October SMB spending trends as healthy, with sales growth remaining near September levels while transaction trends improved to their strongest level since February. While higher gasoline prices continued to support headline growth, spend trends improved across essential categories while remaining flat for discretionary. We note the steady headline growth is consistent with recent commentary from **V/MA**, which both highlighted resilient consumer spending trends through October during their earnings. Retail spending remained healthy despite decelerating from September, supported by continued strength in foot traffic, while restaurant trends improved sequentially but remained pressured by declining traffic. Overall, we continue to see these trends as supportive for payment providers with broad exposure across merchant categories (**FISV/GPN/XYZ**), while continued strength in essentials remains supportive for **CHYM** given its portfolio skew toward non-discretionary, everyday spend.

October Results:

For the month of October, the Fiserv Small Business Index saw total SMB sales at 2.3% YoY (1.3% on an NSA basis) vs 2.2% YoY in September (2.4% on an NSA basis). At the sector level, SMB retail sales growth decelerated to 1.9% YoY in October (vs. growth of 3.0% in September) driven by weaker pricing growth (-0.3% YoY vs. 0.5% in September) and slightly weaker foot traffic growth (2.2% YoY vs. 2.5% in September). Restaurant Spending (Food Services and Drinking Places) declined in

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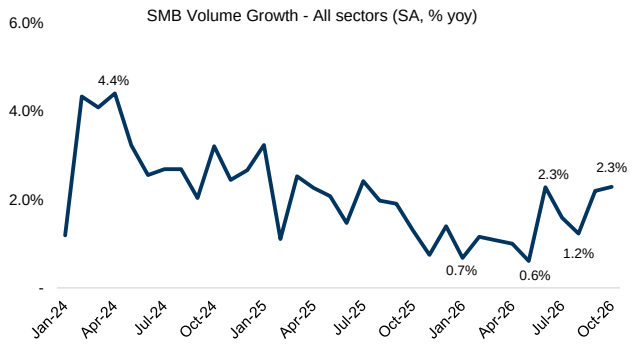
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October (-0.5% YoY vs. -1.0% for September) on the back of an acceleration in foot traffic growth (-2.7% YoY) outweighing a decrease in pricing growth (2.3% YoY).

Read-Throughs:

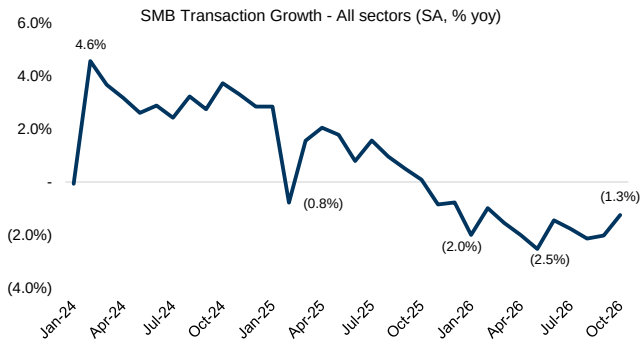
- **FISV/GPN/XYZ (+):** Retail spending remained healthy in October (1.9% YoY), despite decelerating from September (3.0%), with continued strength in foot traffic (2.2% YoY) partially offset by a decline in average ticket sizes (-0.3%). However, growth remained somewhat concentrated in more volatile categories, with retail growing just +0.7% YoY, while gas (23.2%) remained a meaningful contributor to overall spending growth. We continue to view horizontal payment providers as well positioned given their broad exposure across merchant categories and continued resilience in consumer spending trends.
- **TOST/FOUR/XYZ (-/=):** Restaurant spending remained soft but improved sequentially in October (-0.5% YoY vs. -1.0% in September), as transaction declines moderated (-2.7% YoY vs. -3.9%) while average ticket growth slowed to 2.2%. Performance remained bifurcated across formats, with drinking places (3.7% YoY) and full-service restaurants (0.5%) continuing to outperform limited-service restaurants (-2.2%). We view the sequential improvement in traffic as encouraging, although restaurant spending remains below broader SMB trends.

Exhibit 1: SMB sales growth modestly accelerated in October despite a slight deceleration in pricing growth...



Source: Fiserv

Exhibit 2: ...as transaction growth rebounded to its highest level since February



Source: Fiserv

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Exhibit 3: October spend stayed strong even as pricing growth fell relative to September levels

Fiserv SMB Index (% yoy sales growth, SA)

	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	Jul-26	Aug-26	Sep-26	Oct-26
Segments:														
Administrative and Support / Waste Management	4.9%	1.8%	0.8%	1.7%	2.5%	2.3%	0.2%	2.0%	2.0%	2.3%	1.3%	2.8%	2.1%	4.9%
Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services	6.5%	7.7%	5.3%	6.6%	5.0%	4.1%	3.8%	5.0%	2.4%	5.9%	6.5%	5.2%	5.8%	4.6%
Educational Services	2.9%	4.0%	2.4%	2.2%	1.0%	0.1%	0.8%	1.2%	1.8%	2.7%	1.0%	1.0%	2.4%	4.0%
Transportation and Warehousing	4.0%	4.1%	2.9%	5.7%	3.7%	(0.7%)	1.8%	3.0%	(0.9%)	2.4%	(0.6%)	0.9%	4.3%	3.7%
Wholesale Trade	2.1%	1.1%	1.7%	1.7%	1.4%	0.4%	1.2%	0.2%	0.3%	2.8%	2.3%	3.3%	2.7%	3.3%
Accommodation and Food Services	0.4%	(0.1%)	(0.1%)	0.6%	(0.8%)	1.3%	0.9%	0.7%	0.9%	1.8%	1.2%	1.0%	2.0%	2.2%
Retail Trade	1.3%	0.5%	(1.2%)	0.2%	0.1%	0.6%	0.4%	0.1%	0.1%	3.0%	1.9%	0.7%	3.0%	1.9%
Health Care and Social Assistance	2.1%	2.3%	2.4%	1.8%	1.7%	0.9%	1.0%	1.1%	1.4%	1.8%	0.5%	1.8%	1.3%	1.6%
Other Services (except Public Administration)	1.3%	(1.3%)	(0.7%)	(0.3%)	(1.3%)	0.6%	0.5%	0.5%	(0.4%)	0.3%	0.5%	0.3%	0.7%	1.5%
Construction	1.8%	0.6%	1.3%	1.5%	0.8%	0.7%	2.1%	0.9%	0.5%	0.2%	0.4%	(0.2%)	(0.1%)	0.5%
Arts, Entertainment, and Recreation	(5.8%)	(2.1%)	1.6%	(0.9%)	(1.5%)	0.4%	(2.1%)	0.7%	1.1%	0.6%	(0.5%)	(3.6%)	1.1%	0.1%
Information	3.5%	0.9%	(0.6%)	(0.7%)	(1.2%)	(1.1%)	1.8%	(3.3%)	(5.3%)	(3.1%)	(3.9%)	(4.4%)	(6.0%)	(1.3%)
Real Estate and Rental and Leasing	4.2%	2.5%	0.8%	2.3%	3.7%	1.5%	2.2%	(0.2%)	2.4%	0.0%	(6.6%)	(7.2%)	(4.8%)	(6.4%)
Retail Trade Subsegments:														
Gasoline Stations and Fuel Dealers	(1.0%)	(1.3%)	0.2%	(1.4%)	(5.5%)	(3.2%)	12.7%	19.2%	22.7%	15.4%	14.5%	15.6%	21.1%	23.2%
Clothing, Clothing Accessories, Shoe, and Jewelry Rel	4.2%	4.4%	(0.3%)	(1.1%)	3.4%	2.8%	1.9%	0.9%	(0.1%)	4.3%	2.0%	0.6%	1.4%	0.9%
Food and Beverage Retailers	(0.7%)	0.3%	(0.4%)	(0.5%)	(0.5%)	(0.1%)	(1.9%)	(2.4%)	(3.1%)	0.2%	0.5%	(1.3%)	1.9%	(0.1%)
General Merchandise Retailers	1.9%	1.8%	1.1%	0.6%	(15.3%)	(14.1%)	(16.7%)	(13.1%)	(13.4%)	(9.8%)	(11.9%)	(14.1%)	(10.9%)	(12.5%)
Accommodation and Food Services Subsegments:														
Accommodation	(0.4%)	(1.0%)	(0.0%)	2.4%	1.0%	4.4%	6.5%	6.4%	5.4%	7.1%	7.1%	5.7%	10.8%	10.1%
Food Services and Drinking Places	0.7%	0.2%	(0.1%)	(0.0%)	(1.5%)	0.2%	(1.1%)	(1.2%)	(0.6%)	(0.1%)	(0.9%)	(0.7%)	(1.0%)	(0.5%)
SMB Index Total, NSA	3.1%	1.5%	(0.8%)	2.5%	(0.3%)	1.0%	2.0%	1.4%	(0.7%)	3.5%	1.8%	0.8%	2.4%	1.3%
SMB Index Total, SA	1.9%	1.3%	0.8%	1.4%	0.7%	1.2%	1.1%	1.0%	0.6%	2.3%	1.6%	1.2%	2.2%	2.3%

Fiserv SMB Index (implied % yoy ticket growth, SA)

	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	Jul-26	Aug-26	Sep-26	Oct-26
Segments:														
Administrative and Support / Waste Management	0.3%	0.5%	(2.2%)	(1.8%)	3.8%	4.7%	3.8%	11.8%	12.3%	7.6%	7.5%	6.6%	7.6%	5.2%
Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services	(0.8%)	(2.4%)	7.5%	6.3%	6.5%	6.6%	7.8%	11.0%	9.2%	11.4%	14.4%	13.8%	14.3%	14.7%
Educational Services	(0.2%)	0.3%	(1.3%)	0.7%	(0.2%)	0.4%	2.0%	3.6%	1.1%	0.5%	0.9%	(0.4%)	0.1%	(0.3%)
Transportation and Warehousing	19.2%	24.2%	23.5%	15.5%	46.7%	45.0%	14.8%	13.6%	12.8%	13.5%	9.4%	12.1%	17.9%	20.4%
Wholesale Trade	2.9%	2.3%	6.2%	6.4%	3.8%	1.0%	0.1%	1.9%	1.9%	3.0%	3.2%	2.6%	4.1%	3.2%
Accommodation and Food Services	0.8%	1.0%	1.5%	2.2%	2.4%	3.3%	3.8%	4.1%	4.4%	4.9%	4.7%	4.1%	5.6%	4.6%
Retail Trade	(0.1%)	(1.6%)	(2.3%)	(0.9%)	(1.1%)	(0.7%)	(0.6%)	(0.8%)	0.1%	0.4%	(0.3%)	(0.0%)	0.5%	(0.3%)
Health Care and Social Assistance	1.7%	3.2%	3.2%	2.7%	3.4%	2.5%	2.2%	2.7%	2.4%	2.8%	2.4%	2.5%	2.3%	1.9%
Other Services (except Public Administration)	(4.6%)	(1.6%)	(3.0%)	(3.0%)	(0.3%)	(3.3%)	(0.9%)	(0.1%)	(1.3%)	(0.3%)	0.9%	1.6%	2.4%	1.5%
Construction	(3.6%)	(3.6%)	(3.1%)	(4.6%)	(2.8%)	(4.3%)	(5.9%)	(4.7%)	(2.7%)	(0.9%)	(2.9%)	(3.7%)	(4.3%)	(2.8%)
Arts, Entertainment, and Recreation	(10.2%)	(8.4%)	(5.7%)	(6.3%)	(5.8%)	(7.8%)	(5.5%)	(4.9%)	(4.2%)	(4.5%)	(3.0%)	(3.0%)	(3.6%)	(4.6%)
Information	10.5%	7.6%	13.2%	12.5%	9.3%	11.3%	8.5%	6.5%	11.0%	8.5%	1.1%	5.2%	9.5%	11.7%
Real Estate and Rental and Leasing	2.5%	(3.7%)	(0.9%)	(1.6%)	0.8%	(2.5%)	(1.4%)	(1.5%)	4.0%	2.1%	(5.6%)	(2.5%)	(1.5%)	(0.7%)
Retail Trade Subsegments:														
Gasoline Stations and Fuel Dealers	(0.3%)	0.9%	1.9%	1.9%	(0.5%)	1.2%	12.9%	18.7%	22.3%	17.1%	15.8%	16.9%	20.8%	22.1%
Clothing, Clothing Accessories, Shoe, and Jewelry Rel	6.5%	4.7%	5.9%	4.3%	4.0%	0.8%	1.0%	1.9%	(0.2%)	1.5%	(0.8%)	(1.1%)	(4.4%)	(3.2%)
Food and Beverage Retailers	(1.7%)	(1.5%)	(1.2%)	(0.7%)	(1.0%)	(0.5%)	(1.1%)	(1.5%)	(1.1%)	(1.1%)	(0.8%)	(1.2%)	0.5%	(1.0%)
General Merchandise Retailers	2.2%	3.3%	5.1%	5.4%	6.8%	7.6%	5.6%	5.0%	7.6%	5.4%	3.6%	2.7%	2.4%	1.4%
Accommodation and Food Services Subsegments:														
Accommodation	(0.7%)	(2.5%)	(2.1%)	(2.2%)	(2.3%)	(1.6%)	0.5%	(1.4%)	(1.3%)	0.4%	(0.8%)	(0.5%)	(0.0%)	1.0%
Food Services and Drinking Places	1.1%	1.4%	1.6%	1.8%	1.9%	2.4%	2.2%	2.4%	3.2%	3.4%	3.0%	2.7%	3.0%	2.3%
SMB Index Total, NSA	2.5%	1.1%	0.5%	3.1%	1.8%	2.1%	3.9%	3.2%	1.9%	5.1%	3.5%	3.8%	4.0%	2.2%
SMB Index Total, SA	1.4%	1.2%	1.6%	2.2%	2.7%	2.2%	2.7%	3.1%	3.2%	3.8%	3.4%	3.4%	4.3%	3.6%

Source: Fiserv

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